

2.2 Manipulating Image Attributes

The good thing about digital photography is that once you've clicked a picture, it's still open to all sorts of changes. If there's something that doesn't seem to fit in the picture, it can be easily dealt with. In this chapter we show you how you can change some basic image attributes, which can make a world of a difference to the end result.

Basic Colour Manipulation: Though you can set your digital camera to shoot in Black and White or sepia mode, there are times that you would have already shot an image in colour, and later on realised that it would look much better in black and white. Here are some simple Photoshop techniques that will help you achieve that.

Black & White: You can achieve this look the simple way or the hard way. The difference is that the light tones come out looking a lot better the hard way, but it all depends on whether you can be bothered with the technique. We'll show you both the techniques, just in case.

The simple way to convert a colour photo to Black and White is:

- Open the photo in Photoshop
- In the Toolbar, select Image > Mode > Grayscale
- A pop-up will ask you if you wish to discard the other channels; click OK. You're done!

The slightly harder way to do it requires a few more steps:

- Open the photo in Photoshop



TIMESAVER TIP

To create a border, open the photo you want to create a border around. Click the Quick Mask mode button in the toolbox. This will create a Quick Mask channel in the Channels palette. Choose the Rectangular Marquee tool in the toolbox, then select an area in the centre of the image. Choose 'Fill...' from the Edit menu. Fill the selection area with black at 100 per cent opacity. Choose None from the Select menu to deselect the area. Then choose 'Gaussian Blur...' from the Blur sub-menu in the Filter menu. Use a Radius setting of between 10 and 20 pixels. You have now applied the Gaussian Blur to the Quick Mask channel. Select any special effects filter from the Filter menu. Since you are still in Quick Mask mode and there is nothing selected, only the Quick Mask channel will be effected by the filter. Click on the Standard selection mode button in the toolbox. This will select the area of the image that is not masked by the Quick Mask channel. Fill the area with your background color, and you're done.